



Missing in action

With the World Cup rapidly approaching, the 48 participating nations have the arduous task of selecting a maximum of 26 players to board the plane to North America. This means that, inevitably, some will miss the cut. For France, Eduardo Camavinga (**right**) finds himself in that position. The Real Madrid midfielder has been plagued by injuries during a chaotic club season and did not find a place in a French squad stacked with heavyweight names. Meanwhile, Brighton forward Kaoru Mitoma was excluded from Japan's roster after picking up an injury against relegated Wolves in the Premier League. Likely to join him on that list are Matthijs de Ligt (**above**) and Fermin Lopez, with the former recently undergoing back surgery and the Spanish youngster suffering a foot fracture in Barcelona's final home game of the season.



Dick Advocaat set for history

While Curacao is set to become the smallest nation to play on the grandest stage, a piece of history will also be made on the touchline. It's Dutch manager Dick Advocaat, who resigned in February due to personal reasons, opted to return to the side and is set to become the oldest person to take charge of a World Cup match at the age of 78.



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